quantum theory or that of the classical theory.

II.

In every one of the cases cited till now, we encountered a rather simple, easily appreciable situation. Now let us proceed to the consideration of a problem which has always regarded as one of central importance because of its meaning to human life—the famous body-mind problem. In this case, first of all we must try to ascertain the meaning of our problem. For there are philosophers who claim that mental processes need not be accompanied by physical processes at all, but can take place totally independently from the latter. If this view is right, mental processes are subject to entirely different laws than those applying to physical processes. If so, then, the body-mind problems splits into two separate problems—the body problem and the mind problem—thus losing its meaning, and degenerating into a phantom problem. With this finding, the case may be considered as good as closed, and we need only concern ourselves with the reciprocal interaction of mental and physical processes. Experience shows that they are very closely influenced by each other. For instance, somebody asks me a question. His question is introduced by a physical process, the propagation of the sound waves of the spoken words which, emitted by him, hit my ears and are transmitted to my brain through the sensory nerve paths. They then cause mental processes to take place in my brain, namely, a reflection on the meaning of the words perceived, followed by a decision as to the content of the answer to be given. Then another physical process operates my motor nerves and my larynx, to transmit the answer to the questioner by means of the physical process of propagating sound waves through the air.

Now then, what is the nature of the interrelation of physical and mental processes? Are mental processes caused by physical ones? And if so, according to what laws? How can something material act on something immaterial, and *vice versa?* All these questions are difficult to answer. If we assume the existence of a causal interaction, a cause-and-effect relationship, between physical and mental processes, a continued, unrestricted applicability of the principle of the conservation of energy appears to be an indispensable premise. For one will not be disposed to sacrifice this universal foundation of exact science. But in that case, there would have to exist a numerically definite mechanical equivalent of psychic processes, as there is a definite equivalent of heat in thermodynamics, and there would be absolutely no method for measuring such a constant. For this reason, a solution has been attempted on the basis of the hypothesis that the mental forces contribute no perceptible energy to the physical processes, but act merely to liberate the